PADHAKU
Exploring Society: India and Beyond · Class 6 Social Science



CHAPTER 3

Landforms and Life

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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The Big Questions

1 What are the major types of landforms and their significance to life and culture?

✔ ANSWER

There are three major landforms: **mountains, plateaus and plains**.

- Mountains: rivers start from their snow; forests, animals, tourism, pilgrimages; held sacred by many communities.
- Plateaus: 'storehouses of minerals', so mining; waterfalls; lava plateaus have rich black soil.
- Plains: fertile soil from river sediments, so farming; first civilisations grew here; most people live here.

Landforms are part of culture too, e.g. Kālidāsa's poem on the Himalayas and the Tamil tiṇais.

2 What are the challenges and opportunities of life associated with each landform?

✔ ANSWER

Landform	Opportunities	Challenges
Mountains	Tourism, sports, pilgrimage, herding, terrace farming, fresh air	Rough terrain, landslides, avalanches, cloudbursts, flash floods, cold, too many tourists

Plateaus	Mining of minerals, waterfalls, black soil on lava plateaus	Rocky, less fertile soil, so less farming
Plains	Fertile soil, farming, fishing, easy river transport	High population, pollution, falling groundwater

⭐ Introduction · Let's Explore

1 **Form groups of 4–5, observe the school's surroundings. What kind of landscape do you see? Will it change a few km away? Within some 50 km? Compare with other groups.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample: Our school is on a flat plain with fields, roads and houses.

A few kilometres away the land looks the same, but within about 50 km we may see a river, small hills or a forest.

Other groups may have noticed different things, so we compare our lists.

2 **Discuss a journey any of you has made through a region of India. List the different landscapes seen on the way. Compare with other groups.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample: Train journey from Delhi to Shimla:

- Flat plains with wheat fields and rivers (Haryana, Punjab)
- Low hills with forests near Kalka
- High mountains with pine and deodar trees, steep slopes and valleys near Shimla

🤔 Mountains · Think About It

? **What is snow?**

✔ ANSWER

Snow is **precipitation of water in a solid state**. At high altitudes, when it is cold enough, snow falls and covers the land like a soft white blanket. Hail is also solid precipitation.

💬 Mountain environment · Discuss in class (Kālidāsa's Kumārasambhava)

1 **What are the 'western to the eastern oceans'? Can you locate them as well as the 'Lord of mountains' on the map (Fig. 5.2)?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The western ocean is the **Arabian Sea** and the eastern ocean is the **Bay of Bengal**.

The 'Lord of mountains' is the **Himalayas**, in the north of India, stretching from west to east. (Locate them on the map in your book.)

2 **Why is Gangā mentioned? (Hint: There could be several reasons.)**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- The Ganga starts from the Himalayas (it is the largest river from there), so its spray comes down with the mountain wind.
- The Ganga is a sacred river for many Indians.
- It gives water and life to the people, plants and animals of the region.

⭐ Life in the mountains · Let's Explore

1 **Fig. 3.6 shows challenges for people living in the mountains (landslide, flash flood, uncontrolled tourism, avalanche, heavy snowfall, cloudburst, cold weather). Discuss and write one paragraph on each. Also discuss why people still choose to live in the mountains.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample paragraphs:

- **Landslide:** a mass of earth or rock suddenly falls from a mountainside. It blocks roads, damages houses and can kill people.
- **Flash flood:** a sudden local flood, often after a cloudburst. It washes away bridges, houses and fields.
- **Uncontrolled tourism:** too many visitors bring traffic, garbage and pressure on water and forests of the fragile mountains.
- **Avalanche:** snow, ice or rocks suddenly fall, often when snow starts melting. It can bury roads and villages.
- **Heavy snowfall:** roads close, villages are cut off, and food and fuel become hard to get.
- **Cloudburst:** a sudden violent rainstorm that causes floods and landslides.
- **Cold weather:** people need warm clothes and fuel; farming is possible only in some months.

Why people still live there: it is their home and culture; pure air and beautiful scenery; income from tourism, herding and terrace farming; holy places; they have learnt to adapt.

⭐ Plains · Let's Explore (Fig. 3.8)

1. **Use the colour code in Fig. 3.8 to add a landform to each name, e.g. 'Tibetan plateau', 'Rocky range', 'Nile plain'. Names: Ural, Mongolian, Rocky, Alaska, Tibetan, Mississippi, Indus, Himalaya, Atlas, Nile,**

Yangtze, East African, Amazon, Ganga & Brahmaputra, Andes, Patagonian.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Plateau	Mountain range	River plain
Mongolian plateau	Ural range	Mississippi plain
Tibetan plateau	Rocky range	Indus plain
East African plateau	Alaska range	Nile plain
Patagonian plateau	Himalaya range	Yangtze plain
	Atlas range	Amazon plain
	Andes range	Ganga & Brahmaputra plain

(Check the colours on the map in your book.)

⭐ Plains · Let's Explore (Fig. 3.9, satellite view)

1 Which colour is the Ganga plain?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The Ganga plain is **green** (fields and crops). (Check the picture in your book.)

2 What does the white expanse represent?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

The white expanse is the **snow-covered Himalayas** in the north.

3 **What does the brown expanse at the bottom left of the image represent?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

It shows **dry land with little vegetation**: the desert and dry region of Rajasthan (Thar Desert side). (Check the picture in your book.)

⭐ Life in the plains · Let's Explore

1 **Can you give examples of river sources or confluences from your region that are regarded sacred by any community?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample:

- Gangotri (source of the Ganga) and Yamunotri (source of the Yamuna) in Uttarakhand
- Triveni Sangam at Prayagraj (Ganga, Yamuna and the mythical Saraswati)
- Devprayag, where the Bhagirathi and Alaknanda meet to form the Ganga
- Amarkantak, the source of the Narmada

2 **Visit a nearby river and observe all activities there, whether economic or cultural. Note**

them down and discuss with your classmates.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample observations:

- Economic: fishing, boating, washing clothes, watering fields, sand mining, selling flowers and food on the banks
- Cultural: bathing on festivals, prayers and aarti, immersion of idols, fairs on the ghats

3 **Name some popular tourist destinations in India and identify the category of landform they are associated with.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample:

Place	Landform
Shimla, Manali, Darjeeling, Munnar	Mountains
Ranchi (Hundru Falls), Cherrapunji, Hampi	Plateaus
Varanasi, Agra, Prayagraj, Haridwar	Plains
Jaisalmer	Desert

? Questions, activities and projects

1 **In what type of landform is your town / village / city located? Which features mentioned in this chapter do you see around you?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample (for Delhi / Ganga plain): My city is on a **plain**.

Around me I see flat land, a river (Yamuna), farms on the outskirts, many people, canals and some pollution.

2 **Let us go back to our initial trip from Chhota Nagpur to Prayagraj and Almora. Describe the three landforms you came across on the way.**

✔ ANSWER

- **Chhota Nagpur (Jharkhand): plateau** – raised land with a fairly flat top, rocky soil, waterfalls like Hundru Falls, and mines of iron, coal and manganese.
- **Prayagraj (Uttar Pradesh): plain** – the flat, fertile Ganga plain with fields of rice and wheat, many people and the confluence of rivers.
- **Almora (Uttarakhand): mountains** – the Himalayas with steep slopes, pine and deodar forests, terrace farming and cool air.

3 **List a few famous pilgrimage spots in India along with the landforms in which they are found.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Pilgrimage spot	Landform
Kedarnath, Badrinath, Amarnath, Vaishno Devi	Mountains
Varanasi, Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ayodhya	Plains
Tirupati, Sabarimala	Hills / mountains (Eastern and Western Ghats)
Ujjain, Shirdi	Plateaus

4 **State whether true or false:**

✔ ANSWER

- The Himalayas are young mountains with rounded tops. **False** – they are young but have tall, sharp peaks.
- Plateaus usually rise sharply at least on one side. **True** – some of their sides are steep slopes.
- Mountains and hills belong to the same type of landform. **True** – hills are lower highlands with rounded tops.
- Mountains, plateaus and rivers in India have the same types of flora and fauna. **False** – each has different plants and animals.

- Ganga is a tributary to the Yamuna. **False** – the Yamuna is a tributary of the Ganga.
- Deserts have unique flora and fauna. **True**
- Melting snow feeds rivers. **True**
- Sediments from rivers deposited in the plains makes the land fertile. **True**
- All deserts are hot. **False** – some are cold, like the Gobi Desert.

5 **Match words in pairs:**

Column A	Column B
Mount Everest	Africa
rafting	roof of the world
camels	rice fields
plateau	desert
Ganga plains	river
waterway	Ganga
Mount Kilimanjaro	tributary
Yamuna	climbing

✔ ANSWER

Word	Pair
Mount Everest	climbing
rafting	river
camels	desert
plateau	roof of the world
Ganga plains	rice fields
waterway	Ganga

Mount Kilimanjaro	Africa
Yamuna	tributary

🎉 **Chapter 3 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**